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FHS Knowledge and Reality...

FHS Knowledge and Reality: Modality

Question: Do possible worlds other than the actual one exist?

Core Readings

- David Lewis (1986) *On the Plurality of Worlds* (Blackwell), Ch. 1-3.
- Robert Stalnaker (1976) 'Possible Worlds' in *Noûs* 10(1), pp. 65–75.
- Ted Sider (2003) 'Reductive Theories of Modality' in M. J. Loux and D. W. Zimmerman, eds. *The Oxford Handbook of Metaphysics* (OUP), pp. 180-208.

Further Readings

- Joseph Melia (2003) *Modality* (Acumen)
- Phillip Bricker and Joseph Melia (2008) 'Modality and Possible Worlds' in Ted Sider, John Hawthorne, and Dean W. Zimmerman, eds. (2008) *Contemporary Debates in Metaphysics* (Wiley Blackwell).
- Yagisawa, Takashi (2009) “Worlds and individuals” OUP ch 1-2
- William Lycan (1998) 'Possible Worlds and Possibilia' in Cynthia Macdonald and Stephen Laurence, eds. *Contemporary Readings in the Foundation of Metaphysics* (Blackwell).
- Joseph Melia (1992) 'Against Modalism' in *Philosophical Studies* 68(1), pp. 35–56.
- Gideon Rosen (1990) 'Modal Fictionalism' in *Mind* 99(395), pp. 327–354.
- Kit Fine (1994) 'Essence and Modality' in *Philosophical Perspectives* 8, pp. 1–16.
- See the [fac](#) list sections “Transworld identity and Counterpart Theory” and “Essence and Modality” and Stanford articles on “possible worlds” and “counterparts”.

Past Year Essay Questions

EITHER

(a) Are possible worlds properties? If yes, what kind of property? If no, what are









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